

Award
FINRA Dispute Resolution Services

In the Matter of the Arbitration Between:

Claimant

Wells Fargo Clearing Services, LLC

Case Number: 25-01612

vs.

Respondent

Michael Robinson

Hearing Site: Atlanta, Georgia

Awards are rendered by independent arbitrators who are chosen by the parties to issue final, binding decisions. FINRA makes available an arbitration forum—pursuant to rules approved by the SEC—but has no part in deciding the award.

Nature of the Dispute: Member vs. Associated Person

REPRESENTATION OF PARTIES

For Claimant Wells Fargo Clearing Services, LLC (“Claimant”): Keith J. Barnett, Esq., Seth M. Erickson, Esq., and Noah J. Mason, Esq., Troutman Pepper Locke LLP, Atlanta, Georgia.

Respondent Michael Robinson (“Respondent”) appeared pro se.

CASE INFORMATION

Statement of Claim filed on or about: August 6, 2025.

Claimant signed the Submission Agreement: August 6, 2025.

Respondent did not file a Statement of Answer or Submission Agreement.

CASE SUMMARY

In the Statement of Claim, Claimant asserted a cause of action for breach of contract. The cause of action related to Claimant’s allegation that Respondent breached the terms of an executed Settlement Agreement entered into by the parties on or around October 23, 2024 (“Settlement Agreement”), with respect to a promissory note (“Promissory Note”).

RELIEF REQUESTED

In the Statement of Claim, Claimant requested the remaining balance due and owing under the Settlement Agreement in the amount of \$219,184.22; the costs of collection and of this proceeding, including attorneys’ fees, as agreed to under the terms of the Settlement Agreement; and any and all further relief that the Arbitrator deems just and proper.

OTHER ISSUES CONSIDERED AND DECIDED

The Arbitrator acknowledges having read the pleadings and other materials filed by the parties.

Respondent did not file a Statement of Answer. Accordingly, this matter proceeded pursuant to Rule 13807(e)(1) of the Code of Arbitration Procedure ("Code").

The Arbitrator determined that Respondent was served with the Claim Notification letters dated August 20, 2025, and October 16, 2025, by regular mail, and the Overdue Notice (including the Statement of Claim) dated October 10, 2025, by regular and FedEx mail, as evidenced by the FedEx tracking information available online. The Arbitrator also determined that Respondent was served with the Notification of Arbitration dated November 3, 2025, by regular and FedEx mail, as evidenced by the FedEx tracking information available online.

The Claim Notification letter notified Respondent that FINRA rules require parties to use the online DR Portal on a mandatory basis (except pro se investors) and that failure to register for the DR Portal will prevent the submission of pleadings, selection of arbitrators, and receipt of notification relating to case information and deadlines. Respondent failed to register for the DR Portal.

The Arbitrator determined that Respondent is, therefore, bound by the Arbitrator's ruling and determination.

AWARD

After considering the pleadings, the Arbitrator has decided and determined in full and final resolution of the issues submitted for determination as follows:

1. Respondent is liable for and shall pay to Claimant the sum of \$219,184.22 in compensatory damages.
2. Respondent is liable for and shall pay to Claimant the sum of \$4,870.00 in costs.
3. Respondent is liable for and shall pay to Claimant the sum of \$22,000.00 in attorneys' fees pursuant to the Promissory Note.
4. Respondent is liable for and shall pay to Claimant \$1,250.00 to reimburse Claimant for the non-refundable portion of the filing fee previously paid to FINRA Dispute Resolution Services.
5. Respondent is liable for and shall pay to Claimant \$300.00 to reimburse Claimant for the Paper Decision Fee previously paid to FINRA Dispute Resolution Services.
6. Any and all claims for relief not specifically addressed herein are denied.

FEES

Pursuant to the Code, Claimant has paid to FINRA Dispute Resolution Services the \$2,210.00 Member Surcharge previously invoiced and shall pay to FINRA Dispute Resolution Services the \$4,225.00 Member Process Fee previously invoiced.

Claimant has also paid to FINRA Dispute Resolution Services the \$1,250.00 non-refundable portion of the filing fee and the \$300.00 Paper Decision Fee.

ARBITRATOR

Charles E. White

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Sole Public Arbitrator

I, the undersigned Arbitrator, do hereby affirm that I am the individual described herein and who executed this instrument, which is my award.

Arbitrator's Signature

Charles E. White

Charles E. White
Sole Public Arbitrator

12/18/2025

Signature Date

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December 18, 2025

Date of Service (For FINRA Dispute Resolution Services use only)